

CREDIT REPORTING FOR LANDLORDS · REFERENCE

The RentBureau Advantage

The single biggest reason to place a move-out balance instead of writing it off

Most landlords can chase a departed tenant with letters and calls. What they cannot do — and what changes the entire economics of post-eviction recovery — is report that unpaid balance to the database the tenant's next landlord will actually see. That database is Experian RentBureau, and furnishing to it is the differentiator that turns a "never-going-to-pay" balance into a paid one.

Executive summary

- **RentBureau is the largest rental-payment database** — 9M+ residents, with 3,000+ apartment communities reporting every 24 hours.
- It feeds the **tenant-screening report the next landlord pulls**, so an unpaid balance follows the tenant to their next application.
- **Only FCRA-approved furnishers can report to it** — most landlords cannot do this themselves. SWRS does, at no additional charge, as part of standard placement.
- Combined with Equifax and Experian reporting (a **50–100+ point** potential score impact, up to seven years), it is the strongest lawful motivator to pay.

1. What Experian RentBureau is

Experian RentBureau is the largest and most widely used database of rental-payment history in the United States. It aggregates lease and payment data from **more than 3,000 apartment communities**, updated **every 24 hours**, covering **9 million-plus residents**. Crucially, that data flows into the tenant-screening reports and Experian consumer credit files that other operators rely on when deciding whom to approve for a lease.

2. Why it is the landlord's differentiator

A traditional credit tradeline affects a former tenant's general credit. A RentBureau entry does something more targeted and more powerful for a property owner: it surfaces the unpaid balance **precisely where it hurts a delinquent renter most** — on the screening report the next apartment community pulls before approving them.

- **It follows the tenant.** The balance appears when they apply for their next apartment, creating direct pressure to resolve it in order to move.
- **Most landlords can't furnish it themselves.** Reporting to RentBureau requires being an FCRA-approved data furnisher and meeting its data and compliance standards — a bar individual owners and most managers don't clear.
- **SWRS furnishes it for you.** As an approved furnisher, we report qualifying placed accounts to RentBureau **at no additional charge**, as part of standard contingency placement.

3. The full reporting picture

RentBureau is one part of a coordinated reporting approach. On qualifying accounts, SWRS reports to:

BUREAU	EFFECT
Equifax	General consumer credit file — affects loans, cards and housing decisions.
Experian	General consumer credit file, and the gateway to RentBureau data.
Experian RentBureau	Rental-specific screening data — the entry the next landlord sees.

Reported correctly, an unpaid-rent balance can lower a former tenant's credit score by 50–100 points or more and remain on file for up to seven years. (We report to Equifax and Experian plus RentBureau — not to a "third bureau," and RentBureau is the rental-specific value-add that general tradelines can't replicate.)

4. Why it actually gets balances paid

Credit reporting works on post-eviction debt because it changes the tenant's incentives at exactly the moment they need something from the system. A departed tenant may ignore letters for months — until they try to lease their next apartment and discover the balance is standing between them and approval. That is when a long-dormant account converts to a negotiated payoff. The reporting isn't a threat; it is an accurate, compliant record — and it is remarkably effective.

5. Compliance: reporting done correctly

Because residential tenant debt is consumer debt, reporting follows the FDCPA / Reg F sequence:

- **Validation notice** to the consumer with the debt amount, creditor and their rights.
- **A 30-day dispute window** honored before the balance is furnished.
- **Accurate, verifiable furnishing** — only legitimate, documented balances are reported, and disputes are investigated and corrected.
- The tradeline can remain up to **seven years**, and is updated or removed when the balance is resolved.

This is precisely why an FCRA-approved furnisher matters: accurate, compliant reporting is what makes the leverage lawful and durable — and protects the owner from the liability that sloppy self-reporting would create.

Key takeaways

- RentBureau is the largest rental-payment database — 9M+ residents, 3,000+ communities, updated daily.
- It puts the unpaid balance on the screening report the tenant's next landlord pulls.
- Most landlords can't furnish to it; SWRS does, at no additional charge, as an approved furnisher.
- Paired with Equifax + Experian, it's a 50–100+ point, up-to-7-year motivator to pay.
- Compliant, accurate reporting (Reg F validation + 30-day dispute) is what makes it stick.

Getting started in three steps

1. Place qualifying move-out balances through the portal with your ledger and lease documentation.
2. We validate, honor the dispute window, and furnish qualifying accounts to Equifax, Experian and RentBureau.
3. Watch dormant balances convert as former tenants apply for their next lease.

Frequently asked questions

Can we report to RentBureau ourselves?

Generally not — furnishing to RentBureau requires being an FCRA-approved data furnisher meeting its data and compliance standards, a bar most owners and managers don't clear. SWRS reports for you, at no additional charge.

How quickly does reporting drive payment?

Often the moment the former tenant applies for their next apartment and finds the balance on their screening report standing between them and approval.

How long does the entry stay, and what happens when they pay?

Up to seven years; the tradeline is updated or removed once the balance is resolved.

Is RentBureau the same as reporting to "all three bureaus"?

No. We report to Equifax and Experian, plus Experian RentBureau — the rental-specific database. RentBureau is the landlord value-add a general tradeline can't replicate.

Quick reference — the RentBureau advantage

- **What:** Experian RentBureau — largest rental-payment database (9M+ residents, 3,000+ communities, 24-hour updates).
- **Why:** the balance appears on the next landlord's screening report.
- **Who can report:** FCRA-approved furnishers only — SWRS furnishes it for you, no extra charge.
- **Full stack:** Equifax + Experian + Experian RentBureau (not TransUnion).
- **Impact:** ~50–100+ point drop, up to 7 years, cleared on payment.

About Southwest Recovery Services

Southwest Recovery Services is a property-management and multifamily recovery specialist working post-eviction and unpaid-rent balances on pure contingency since 2004 — with a strong Texas footprint and the FCRA-approved credit-reporting standing most landlords can't furnish themselves.

AT A GLANCE	
Recovering since	2004 — two decades of receivables recovery.
Track record	\$975M+ in receivables placed; \$76M+ recovered for clients; 800,000+ accounts worked.
Texas footprint	12 offices across 7 states — six in Texas (Addison HQ, Austin, Dallas, Houston, Midland, San Antonio); recovery nationwide.
Credit reporting	Equifax and Experian, plus Experian RentBureau — the rental-specific value-add, furnished at no additional charge.
Model & compliance	Pure contingency (\$0 upfront); FDCPA / Reg F compliant on residential accounts; ACA International member.

Make your balances impossible to ignore

Ask us how RentBureau furnishing works on your portfolio — it's included in standard contingency placement, at no additional charge.

Call [\(866\) 551-4684](tel:8665514684) · sdietz@swrecovery.com · swrecovery.com

Provided for general informational purposes; not legal advice. Recovery figures are illustrative and vary by portfolio; statutes and court timelines vary by jurisdiction — confirm with counsel. Southwest Recovery Services does not collect consumer debt in California, Oregon or Washington.